Census and Urbanisation Topic 1 — Census and Population Data

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → UP Special Topic 6. This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Teaching cards

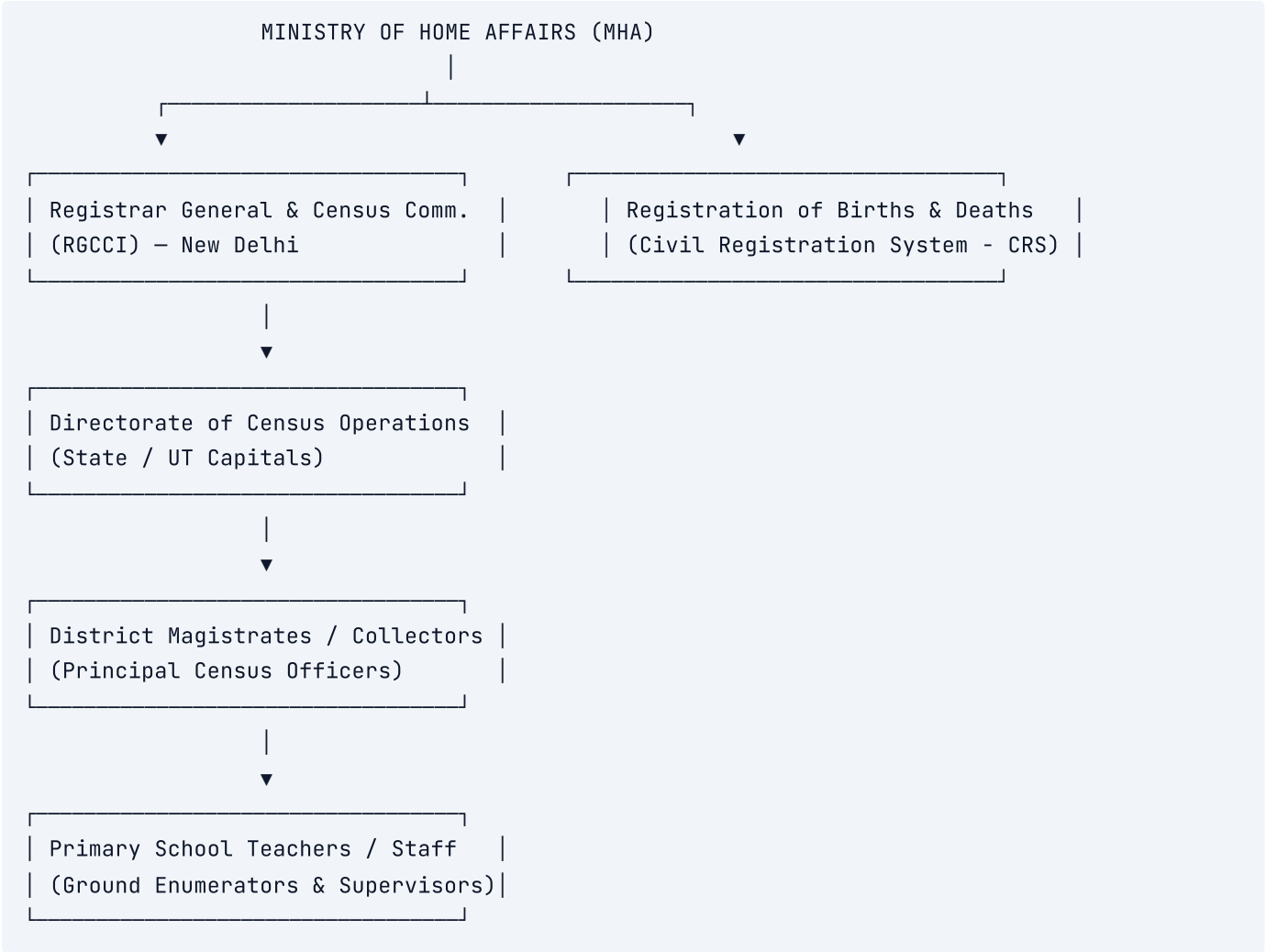
2.1 Constitutional, Legal, and Institutional Framework of Census in India

A. Constitutional Allocation & Statutory Authority

- **Union Subject**: Under **Article 246** of the Constitution of India, Census is a subject allocated exclusively to the Union Government (**Entry 69 in the Union List / List I of the Seventh Schedule**). State governments have no legislative competence to conduct a national census.
- **The Census Act, 1948 (Act No. 37 of 1948)**:
- Piloted through the Constituent Assembly (Legislative) by India's first Home Minister, **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**.
- Provides permanent statutory backing for conducting decennial censuses, appointment of census officers, duties of citizens to provide truthful answers, and strict penalties for refusal or false information.
- **Confidentiality Clause (Section 15)**: Individual census records are strictly confidential and privileged. They are immune from production in any civil, criminal, or revenue court as evidence against the individual.
- **The Census Rules, 1990**: Notified under Section 18 of the Census Act to lay down administrative guidelines, schedules, and enumeration procedures.

B. Institutional Machinery: Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner (ORGI)

- Operates as an attached office under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, Government of India.
- **Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India (RGCCI)**: The apex statutory civil authority in charge of planning, organizing, executing, and tabulating the decennial National Census and administering the **Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969**.
- **State/UT Level**: Headed by the **Director of Census Operations (DCO)**.
- **District Level**: The **District Magistrate / Collector** functions *ex-officio* as the **Principal Census Officer (PCO)**, assisted by Tahsildars / Sub-Divisional Magistrates as Charge Officers.



2.2 Census Methodology: Two-Phase Architecture & Counting Approaches

A. The Two Distinct Phases of Indian Census

1. **Phase 1: House Listing and Housing Census (HLO)**: - Conducted 6 to 8 months prior to the population count (typically April to September of the year preceding the census year). - Prepares detailed geospatial house numbering, building materials, amenities (drinking water, sanitation, cooking fuel, electricity), assets (bank account, telephone, television, vehicles), and identifies living conditions of households.
2. **Phase 2: Population Enumeration (PE)**: - The actual head count conducted simultaneously across the entire nation (typically from **9th February to 28th February**, with a **Revision Round from 1st to 5th March** to update births and deaths occurring prior to the sunrise of 1st March). - Enumerates demographic, social, cultural, educational, economic, and migration characteristics of every individual residing in the country.

B. De Jure vs De Facto Census Methods

- **De Facto Method**: Individuals are counted strictly where they are physically present on the census reference night, regardless of their habitual or permanent residence. (Used in the UK and in historical British censuses).
- **De Jure Method**: Individuals are counted strictly at their normal/habitual place of residence, irrespective of where they happen to be on the enumeration night. (Used in the United States).

- **India's Adopted Method**: India follows an **extended de facto / modified de jure approach**. A person is enumerated at their place of normal residence if they have stayed there for the major part of the enumeration period (or are expected to stay during the reference period). Non-habitual visitors and homeless populations are counted on the night of 28th February.

2.3 Vital Statistics Systems & Alternative Demographic Data Sources

Demographic System / Survey	Operating Agency / Ministry	Core Mandate & Frequency	Key Statistical Indicators Produced
Civil Registration System (CRS)	Office of Registrar General of India (ORGI), MHA	Mandatory continuous legal recording of all vital events under **Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969**.	Administrative count of registered births, deaths, stillbirths, and Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB).
Sample Registration System (SRS)	Office of Registrar General of India (ORGI), MHA	Dual-record sample survey operating continuously since **1969–70**.	**Official annual baseline** for Crude Birth Rate (CBR), Crude Death Rate (CDR), Infant Mortality Rate (IMR), Total Fertility Rate (TFR), and Life Expectancy.
National Family Health Survey (NFHS)	International Institute for Population Sciences (**IIPS**), Mumbai under **MoHFW**	Multi-round nationwide sample survey (NFHS-1: 1992-93; NFHS-2: 1998-99; NFHS-3: 2005-06; NFHS-4: 2015-16; **NFHS-5: 2019-21**).	Maternal and child health, institutional births, immunization, malnutrition, anemia, contraception prevalence, and fertility rates.
Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)	National Statistical Office (**NSO**), MoSPI	Continuous annual and quarterly survey (launched April 2017).	Labour force participation rate (LFPR), worker population ratio (WPR), and unemployment rate (UR).

Bilingual Terminology — Census and Population Data (जनगणना एवं जनसंख्या डेटा)

English Term	हिंदी पारिभाषिक शब्द	Key Exam Anchor
Census (जनगणना)	जनगणना	Entry 69, Union List; Census Act 1948
Decadal Growth Rate (दशकीय वृद्धि दर)	दशकीय जनसंख्या वृद्धि दर	17.70% (2001–2011)
Population Density (जनसंख्या घनत्व)	जनसंख्या घनत्व	382/km² India; 829/km² UP
Sex Ratio (लिंगानुपात)	लिंगानुपात	943 India; 912 UP (2011)
Child Sex Ratio (बाल लिंगानुपात)	बाल लिंगानुपात (0–6 वर्ष)	919 India; 902 UP (2011)
Literacy Rate (साक्षरता दर)	साक्षरता दर	73.0% India; 67.7% UP (2011)

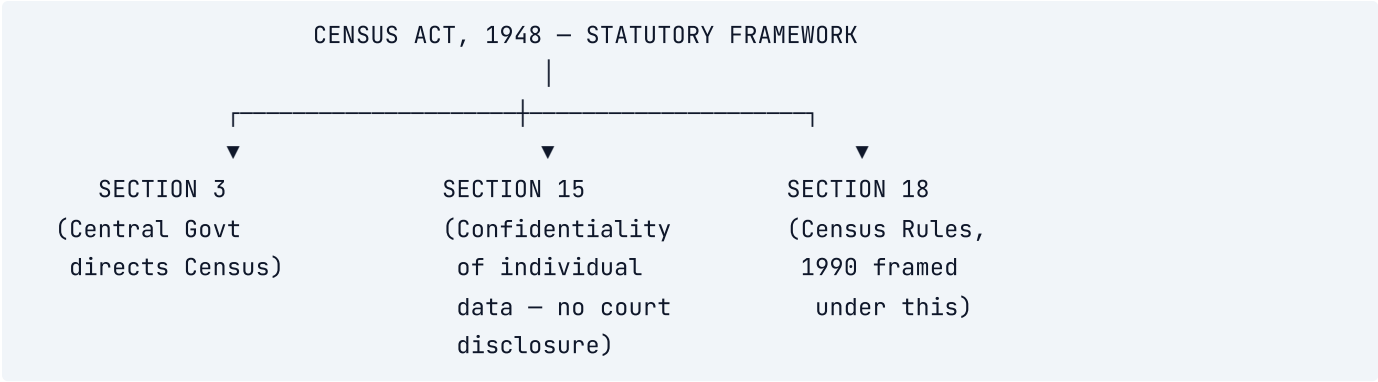
English Term	हिंदी पारिभाषिक शब्द	Key Exam Anchor
Scheduled Caste (अनुसूचित जाति)	अनुसूचित जाति (SC)	16.63% of India; UP has largest absolute SC
Scheduled Tribe (अनुसूचित जनजाति)	अनुसूचित जनजाति (ST)	8.61% of India; MP has largest absolute ST
Urbanisation (नगरीकरण)	नगरीकरण / शहरीकरण	31.16% urban (2011); up from 27.81% (2001)
Sample Registration System	नमूना पंजीकरण प्रणाली (SRS)	Official source for CBR, CDR, IMR, TFR
Civil Registration System	नागरिक पंजीकरण प्रणाली (CRS)	Registration of Births & Deaths Act, 1969
Enumerator (गणनाकर्ता)	परिगणक / गणनाकर्ता	Primary Census enumerator = school teacher
Registrar General	महापंजीयक एवं जनगणना आयुक्त	Under MHA; Census 2011 = Dr. C. Chandramouli
De Facto Census	वास्तविक जनगणना	Count where physically present on census night
De Jure Census	विधिक निवास जनगणना	Count at normal/habitual place of residence
Year of Great Divide	महाविभाजन वर्ष	1921 — only negative growth (-0.31%) in Indian census

Extended Theory — Constitutional, Legal and Demographic Framework

2.4 The Census Act, 1948 — Detailed Provisions (Census Act 1948 के विस्तृत प्रावधान)

The **Census Act, 1948 (Act No. 37 of 1948)** is the foundational statute for all census operations in India. Key sections include:

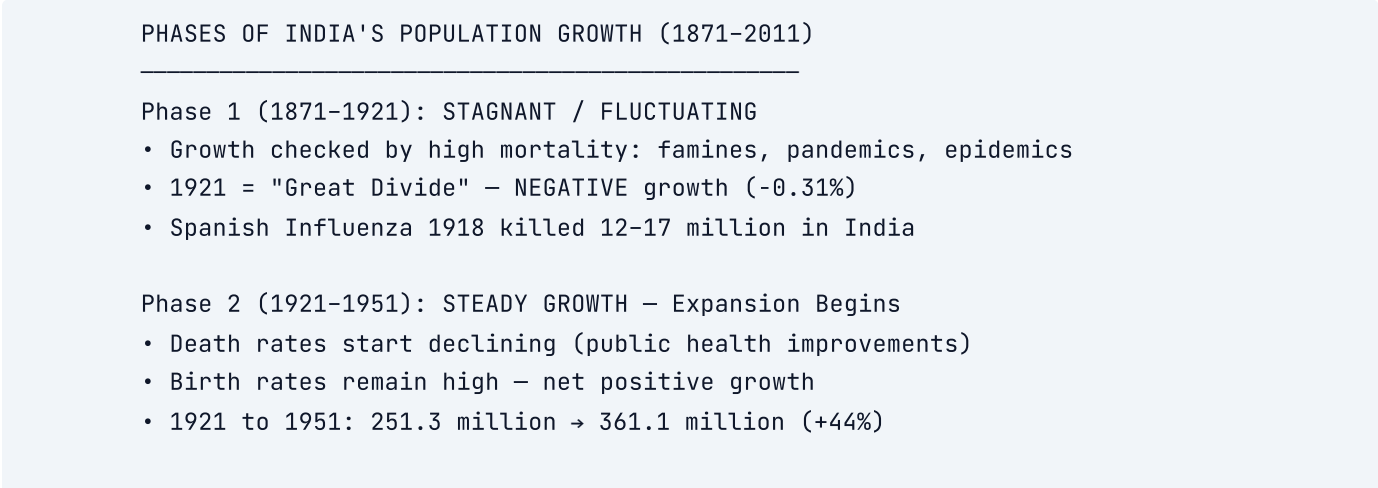
Section	Provision
Section 3	Power of Central Government to direct a census
Section 4	Appointment of Census Commissioner, Directors, and other officers
Section 5	Duties of local authorities in assisting census operations
Section 8A	Duties of householders to answer questions truthfully
Section 11	Prohibition on canvassing for business in connection with census
Section 13	Penalty for non-cooperation or furnishing false data
Section 15	**Confidentiality** — individual census data cannot be used in any civil/criminal court against the individual
Section 18	Rule-making power → led to Census Rules, 1990



2.5 Census Enumeration Process — Phase-by-Phase Architecture



2.6 Population Growth History — Phases of Indian Demographic History



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Phase 3 (1951–1981): RAPID / EXPLOSIVE GROWTH
• Peak growth period: 1961–71 rate = 24.80% (highest ever)
• "Population explosion" era
• 1981 population: 683.3 million

Phase 4 (1981–2011): DECELERATING GROWTH
• Declining fertility; family planning gains
• 2001–2011 decadal growth rate: 17.70% (down from 21.54%)
• Female literacy, urbanisation driving demographic transition

2021 CENSUS: POSTPONED (due to COVID-19)
• First time since 1871 that India missed a decennial census
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2.7 Uttar Pradesh Demographic Analysis (उत्तर प्रदेश की जनांकिकीय विशेषताएँ)

UP's Demographic Significance: - UP's population (19.98 Crore) exceeds that of **Brazil** (world's 6th most populous country). - If UP were a sovereign nation, it would rank **5th globally** by population (after China, India, USA, Indonesia). - UP accounts for **16.51%** of India's total population while occupying only **7.34%** of India's geographical area. - UP's density (829/km²) is more than **double** the national average (382/km²). - UP has the largest number of districts (**75 districts**) of any Indian State. - UP has the second largest number of Lok Sabha constituencies (**80 seats**), after zero at the Union level.

UP's Key Demographic Weaknesses: - **Sex Ratio**: 912 — well below national average of 943 - **Child Sex Ratio**: 902 — significantly below national 919 - **Literacy gap**: 20.1 percentage points (M: 77.3% vs F: 57.2%) vs national 16.3% - **Fertility rate**: TFR of ~3.1 (above national ~2.2) per SRS

One-Liner Revision — Census and Population Data

#	Fast Fact
1	Census = Entry **69**, **Union List**, Seventh Schedule
2	Census Act = **1948**; piloted by **Sardar Patel**
3	First census = **1872** (non-synchronous, Lord Mayo)
4	First decennial synchronous census = **1881** (Lord Ripon, W. C. Plowden)
5	Year of Great Divide = **1921** (negative growth −0.31%)
6	Last caste census (all castes) = **1931** (J. H. Hutton)
7	Census 2011 motto = **"Our Census, Our Future"**
8	Census 2011 Commissioner = **Dr. C. Chandramouli**
9	India population 2011 = **121.08 Crore (17.5% of world)**
10	Decadal growth 2001–11 = **17.70%**
11	Density 2011 = **382/km²** (up from 325 in 2001)

#	Fast Fact
12	Sex ratio 2011 = **943** (up from 933 in 2001)
13	Child sex ratio 2011 = **919** (DOWN from 927 in 2001)
14	Literacy rate 2011 = **73.0%** (Male 80.9%, Female 64.6%)
15	Highest literacy State = **Kerala (94.0%)**
16	Lowest literacy State = **Bihar (61.8%)**
17	Highest sex ratio State = **Kerala (1,084)**
18	Lowest sex ratio State = **Haryana (879)**
19	Highest density State = **Bihar (1,106/km²)**
20	Lowest density State = **Arunachal Pradesh (17/km²)**
21	Highest density UT = **Delhi (11,320/km²)**
22	Highest growth State = **Meghalaya (27.95%)**
23	Negative growth State = **Nagaland (–0.58%)**
24	UP population 2011 = **19.98 Crore (16.51% of India)**
25	UP density = **829/km²** (4th highest State)
26	UP sex ratio = **912**; Child sex ratio = **902**
27	UP literacy = **67.7%** (M: 77.3%, F: 57.2%)
28	UP highest density district = **Ghaziabad (3,971/km²)**
29	UP highest literacy district = **Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)**
30	UP highest sex ratio district = **Jaunpur (1,024)**
31	UP highest SC population = **UP (4.14 Crore; 20.70%)**
32	Highest SC % State = **Punjab (31.9%)**
33	Highest ST absolute = **Madhya Pradesh (1.53 Crore)**
34	Highest ST % = **Lakshadweep (94.8%) / Mizoram (94.4%)**
35	Urban population 2011 = **31.16%** (rural 68.84%)
36	Most urbanised State = **Goa (62.2%)**
37	Least urbanised State = **Himachal Pradesh (10.0%)**
38	States with ZERO ST = **Punjab, Haryana, Delhi, Chandigarh, Puducherry**
39	States with ZERO SC = **Nagaland, Mizoram, Meghalaya, Lakshadweep, A&N**
40	SRS = official source for **IMR, TFR, CBR, CDR**
41	NFHS implementing agency = **IIPS Mumbai** under MoHFW

#	Fast Fact
42	Section 15 Census Act = **individual data confidential**
43	Census 2021 = postponed due to COVID-19
44	Census 2011 = 15th since 1872; 7th since Independence
45	Highest child sex ratio State = **Mizoram (970)**
46	Lowest child sex ratio State = **Haryana (834)**
47	UP Shravasti = lowest literacy district (**46.74%**)
48	UP Kanpur Nagar = highest female literacy (**75.05%**)
49	UP Balrampur = highest child sex ratio (**950**)
50	UP Mahoba = least populous district (**8.75 Lakh**)